

## A Star That Shines on All

### **Matthew 2:1-2, 9-12**

After Jesus was born in Bethlehem in Judea, during the time of King Herod, Magi from the east came to Jerusalem and asked, "Where is the one who has been born king of the Jews? We saw his star when it rose and have come to worship him."

After they had heard the king, they went on their way, and the star they had seen when it rose went ahead of them until it stopped over the place where the child was. When they saw the star, they were overjoyed. On coming to the house, they saw the child with his mother Mary, and they bowed down and worshiped him. Then they opened their treasures and presented him with gifts of gold, frankincense and myrrh. And having been warned in a dream not to go back to Herod, they returned to their country by another route.

*In the name of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.*

Picture a dark night with a bright star shining in the sky, so big and clear that you can't miss it. Now picture people traveling a long distance, following that light. They don't know exactly where they're going, but they trust that the star will lead them to someone incredibly important.

This is exactly what happened with the Magi in today's reading. The Magi were wise men from a distant foreign land. They saw something special in the sky: a new star that announced the birth of a king. These men weren't Jewish, and they hadn't grown up with God's promises about a Savior. But God still reached out to them, using a prophecy and a star to bring them to Jesus.

The Magi's story reminds us that Jesus came to be the Savior not just for one nation, but for the whole world. His love is for all people, from every background and every place. God didn't just shine his light on the people closest to him; He sent it far and wide, guiding people from distant lands to find the Savior. The Magi traveled a long way and faced obstacles, but they followed that light because they trusted it would lead them to something amazing.

When they finally reached Jesus, they were "overjoyed." They bowed down, worshiped him, and gave him precious gifts. The Magi saw Jesus not as just another baby, but as the King worthy of their very best. Maybe we don't follow a star so bright you can see it during the day, but the bright light of who Jesus is has dawned on you, too. He gave his best to you when you were baptized in the name of the Father, Son, and Holy Spirit. It comes to you whenever someone shares God's Word with you (like right now!) and when you hear the best news of God's love, you are "overjoyed!"

A wise child today is one who follows the light of God and shares the light of his love. God's light isn't for just one place or one people; it shines on all, inviting everyone to come and worship the newborn King!

*The questions below are to help families discuss this devotion. The questions are divided by age group as suggestions, but anyone could reflect on any of the questions as they desire.*

### **Questions for the Younger Children**

- Remember the last time you were in the dark and needed a light? How did it feel to have that light to guide you?
- How did the wise men feel when they saw the star and found Jesus?

### **Questions for Elementary Age Children**

- Why do you think God used a star to guide the Magi to Jesus? How does God guide us to Jesus today?
- The Magi gave their gifts to Him. Imagine you have \$1-, 5-, and 10-dollar bills in your hand. You want to give Jesus one of them as a gift. Which one would you give? And why?

### **Questions for Middle School and Above**

- Light doesn't just lead; it exposes things we'd rather keep hidden. Why would someone not want the light of Jesus to shine on them if that's the case?
- The Magi saw Jesus as their King. What ways in your life display to others that Jesus is your King?

### **Closing Prayer:**

Father in heaven, you let the light of your Son, Jesus, shine on all people. That means us! Help us to reflect the light of Jesus in everything we think, do, and say so that more people everywhere might come and worship their King! Amen.